

KEY TOPIC 2 COURSE TEXTBOOK • CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1964–1973

THE ESCALATING CONFLICT

From the Water Wars and Six-Day War to the Yom Kippur Surprise



ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD • 7 JUNE 1967

GPO-ISRAEL / ACC-1967-06-07

Paratroopers at the Western Wall (David Rubinger)

Israeli paratroopers Zion Karasenti, Yitzhak Yifat, and Haim Oshri stand before the Western Wall moments after capturing the Old City of Jerusalem.

GOVERNMENT PRESS OFFICE ARCHIVE

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT

KEY TOPIC 2 COVERAGE

2.1 THE OUTBREAK OF WAR, 1967

- **Water Wars:** Arab diversion of River Jordan headwaters; Israeli strikes.
- **Border Tensions:** Samu reprisal raid; April 1967 Syrian air battles.
- **May 1967 Escalation:** Soviet false reports; Nasser expels UNEF peacekeepers.
- **Blockade:** Egyptian forces close Straits of Tiran; Arab pacts.
- **Casus Belli:** Israeli pre-emptive strike on 5 June 1967.

2.2 THE SIX-DAY WAR & IMPACT

- **Operation Focus:** Destruction of Egyptian Air Force in dawn blitz.
- **Triple Front Victory:** Sinai (Egypt), West Bank (Jordan), Golan (Syria).
- **Territorial Quadrupling:** Conquered lands create 1M new refugees.
- **Khartoum Summit:** Arab 'Three Noes' (No peace, recognition, talks).
- **UN Resolution 242:** 'Land for Peace' formula establishes basis for talks.

2.3 RESISTANCE & YOM KIPPUR

- **Armed Struggle:** Battle of Karameh (1968); Yasser Arafat leads PLO.
- **International Terror:** PFLP aircraft hijackings; Black September (1970).
- **Munich Olympics (1972):** Hostage crisis and Israeli reprisals.
- **Yom Kippur War (1973):** Egyptian canal crossing; Syrian assault.
- **Superpower Alert & Oil:** US-Soviet airlift crisis; OPEC oil embargo.

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS CHRONOLOGY

- Jan 1964
- Cairo Summit: PLO Founded
- ↓
- Nov 1966
- Samu Reprisal Raid in West Bank
- ↓
- 7 Apr 67
- Air Dogfight: 6 Syrian MiGs Downed
- ↓
- May 1967
- UNEF Expelled; Tiran Blockaded
- ↓
- 5–10 Jun
- Pre-emptive Six-Day Victory

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS CHRONOLOGY

- 10 Jun 67
- Ceasefire: Territory Expands x3
- ↓
- Sep 1967
- Khartoum 'Three Noes' Resolution
- ↓
- Nov 1967
- UN Resolution 242 (Land for Peace)
- ↓
- Sep 1970
- Dawson's Field & Black September
- ↓
- Sep 1972
- Munich Olympics Hostage Massacre

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS CHRONOLOGY

- 1969–70
- War of Attrition along Suez Canal
- ↓
- Sep 1970
- Death of Nasser; Sadat President
- ↓
- Jul 1972
- Sadat Expels 15,000 Soviets
- ↓
- 6 Oct 73
- Surprise Assault on Yom Kippur
- ↓
- 25 Oct 73
- Sharon Crossing & Res 338 Ceasefire

KEY TOPIC 2.1 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.1 Enquiry: How Did Water, Border Raids, and Rhetoric Make a Second Arab-Israeli War Inevitable? (1964–1967)

Pearson Specification Focus: Significance of the 1964 Cairo Conference & growth of Fatah and the PLO • Escalating border tension: Syrian support for Fatah, the Samu reprisal raid, and the 7 April 1967 air dogfight • Pre-war actions of the USSR, Nasser, and the USA (UNEF expulsion & Straits of Tiran blockade).

The 1964 Cairo Conference & The Water Wars

[1.1] In January 1964, the heads of state of the Arab League gathered in Cairo at the invitation of Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser. The immediate catalyst for the summit was Israel's completion of the National Water Carrier—a massive engineering pipeline designed to pump water from the Sea of Galilee to irrigate farms in central Israel and the southern Negev desert. Arab governments viewed this project as an aggressive attempt to absorb more Jewish immigrants and strengthen Israel's economy. At Cairo (Source A), Arab leaders agreed on two major policies: they voted to create the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) to give the Palestinian people an official political voice, and they approved a joint Arab plan to build canals diverting the headwaters of the River Jordan inside Syria and Lebanon, which would strip Israel of roughly one-third of its freshwater supply.

[1.2] The dispute over water quickly turned into active warfare along the northern border. Between 1964 and 1966, Israeli tanks and aircraft repeatedly shelled Syrian construction sites and earth-moving machinery, bringing the Arab diversion scheme to a complete halt. At the exact same time, Palestinian nationalist guerrillas belonging to Fatah—led by Yasser Arafat—began staging hit-and-run sabotage operations across the armistice lines, targeting Israeli water pumps, railways, and border settlements. In February 1966, a radical military coup in Syria brought hardline officers to power in Damascus who openly pledged to sponsor Fatah and support a "popular liberation war" to destroy the state of Israel.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

January 1964

Arab Heads of State at the First Arab League Summit in Cairo (January 1964)



Egyptian State Information Service / Arab League Secretariat Archive, January Cairo (Accession Ref: ARA-LEAG-1964-DOC08). 1964

KEY FIGURE

1918–1970



Gamal Abdel Nasser
PRESIDENT OF EGYPT (1954–1970)

As the charismatic leader of Pan-Arab nationalism, Nasser faced intense domestic and regional pressure after the Samu and Golan clashes. His brinkmanship and closure of the Straits of Tiran directly triggered the pre-emptive Israeli air offensive.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Convened the 1964 Cairo Summit, creating the PLO to harness Palestinian nationalism under Arab control.
- Demanded the complete withdrawal of the UN Emergency Force (UNEF) from the Sinai buffer zone on 16 May 1967.
- Closed the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping on 22 May 1967, which Israel treated as an act of war.

Syrian Border Clashes & Israeli Reprisals

[2.1] Between 1965 and 1967, the border between northeastern Israel and Syria became the most dangerous frontier in the Middle East. Syrian artillery batteries perched atop the towering volcanic plateau of the Golan Heights held complete tactical dominance over the low-lying Israeli kibbutzim (farming communities) in the Hula Valley below. Syrian gunners routinely fired machine guns and artillery shells down at Israeli tractors attempting to cultivate fields within the disputed demilitarised border zones. Israeli farmers were forced to drive custom-armored tractors to plough their fields under fire, while Israeli school children were evacuated to sleep in reinforced underground concrete bomb shelters. (Source B) illustrates the commanding geographical position of the Syrian fortifications on the Golan Heights, showing why this frontier became a continuous combat zone.

[2.2] In response to these border attacks and ongoing Fatah sabotage raids, the Israeli military High Command adopted a policy of aggressive retaliation. Israeli leaders, including Chief of Staff Yitzhak Rabin and Prime Minister Levi Eshkol, warned that Israel held host governments directly accountable for any guerrilla attacks launched from their territory. Rather than deterring raids, this hardline policy locked both sides into an escalating cycle of violence: every guerrilla landmine was answered by Israeli artillery barrages and air strikes, which in turn provoked Syrian counter-bombardments and calls across the Arab world for revenge.

SOURCE B HISTORICAL MAP

1964–1967

The Syrian Armistice Line and Golan Heights Overlooking Israeli Settlements (1964–1967)



Department of Military Survey, Historical Topographical Record, Sheet 1964–4 (Accession Ref: ISR-SYR-66). 1967

The Samu Raid & The 7 April 1967 Dogfight

[3.1] By late 1966, this cycle of violence triggered two major military explosions that brought the Middle East to the brink of war. On 11 November 1966, an Israeli border patrol vehicle struck a Fatah landmine near the southern West Bank border, killing three Israeli soldiers. Although the guerrillas had crossed from Jordan, King Hussein of Jordan had actively tried to suppress Fatah to avoid Israeli retaliation. Nevertheless, on 13 November 1966, Israeli forces launched a massive daytime reprisal attack on the West Bank town of Samu. Israeli armored forces destroyed dozens of houses and clashed fiercely with the Jordanian army, leaving 15 Jordanian soldiers and three civilians dead. The Samu raid provoked furious riots across the West Bank, with Palestinians denouncing King Hussein for failing to defend them and demanding weapons to fight Israel.

[3.2] The decisive military clash occurred five months later on 7 April 1967 along the Syrian frontier. When Syrian gunners opened fire on an Israeli tractor working disputed land near Lake Tiberias, Israeli tanks and aircraft retaliated. The battle rapidly expanded into a massive aerial dogfight. Israeli Air Force Mirage jet fighters intercepted Syrian MiG-21s, pursuing them across the border and shooting down six Syrian jets in full view of spectators over Damascus. (Source C) records the intense humiliation felt in Damascus following this aerial defeat. Syrian radio broadcasts furiously accused President Nasser of Egypt of cowardice, taunting him for hiding behind United Nations peacekeepers in the Sinai while Syrian pilots were killed. By May 1967, Nasser felt his leadership of the Arab world was under direct threat, setting the stage for the fatal moves that led to the Six Day War.

SOURCE C DIPLOMATIC DISPATCH7 April 1967

The 7 April 1967 Air Battle and Arab Political Repercussions

"Following the shooting down of six Syrian MiG-21 fighters over Damascus on 7 April, intense political pressure has gripped both Damascus and Cairo. Syrian authorities and state media have expressed profound outrage at Egypt's failure to intervene, openly questioning the value of the November 1966 Egyptian-Syrian Defence Agreement. Radio Damascus and Syrian editorial columns have launched stinging taunts against President Gamal Abdel Nasser, pointedly asking why 100,000 Egyptian troops and hundreds of jet fighters remain inactive behind the shield of the United Nations Emergency Force (UNEF) in the Sinai Peninsula while Israeli aircraft strike Syrian territory with impunity. Western diplomatic observers in Cairo confirm that this sustained public humiliation has gravely damaged Nasser's prestige as the undisputed leader of the Arab world, making it virtually impossible for him to remain inactive during the next border crisis without facing complete political delegitimization."

Diplomatic Telegram, Foreign & Commonwealth Office Archive, Middle East Department (Ref: FCO 17/289, April 1967).7 April 1967

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH RADIO CAIRO BROADCAST26 May 1967

President Nasser's Address to Arab Trade Unionists

"The battle will be a general one and our basic objective will be to destroy Israel. We probably could not have said such things five or even three years ago. Today I say such words because I am confident. We are now ready to confront Israel in battle."

Voice of the Arabs / Egyptian State Information ServiceCairo. 26 May 1967

Why Was War Inevitable by Spring 1967?

[4.1] By May 1967, the Middle East had reached a critical flashpoint. Three interconnected factors had created an inescapable crisis: first, the conflict over the River Jordan water supply had transformed natural resources into a justification for military strikes; second, the rise of independent Palestinian guerrilla groups like Fatah, backed by the radical Syrian government, guaranteed continuous border violence; and third, Israel's uncompromising policy of massive military retaliation ensured that local skirmishes escalated into major battles.

[4.2] Historians emphasize that while neither Israeli leaders nor President Nasser actively wanted a full-scale war in the spring of 1967, both sides had painted themselves into diplomatic corners. When false Soviet intelligence arrived in Cairo in mid-May claiming Israel was massing twelve brigades to invade Syria, Nasser felt he had no choice but to march his army into the Sinai to defend his Arab allies. The regional escalation that began at the 1964 Cairo Conference had built a momentum that diplomacy could no longer restrain.

HISTORICAL CONTEXTWATER SECURITY & ESCALATION

The Battle Over the Headwaters: The Jordan River Diversion

In 1964, Israel completed its National Water Carrier, drawing freshwater from Lake Tiberias (Sea of Galilee) to irrigate the arid Negev Desert. In response, Arab League states launched the Headwater Diversion Scheme to divert the Dan and Banias tributaries away from Israel into Syria and Jordan, threatening 35% of Israel's freshwater supply. Israeli artillery strikes and airstrikes systematically obliterated the Syrian earthworks between 1965 and 1967. Simultaneously, Syrian artillery on the Golan Heights shelled Israeli kibbutzim in the Hula Valley below, turning regional water control into the initial catalyst of total war.

Key Causation: Proved that border escalation predated troop mobilizations: water security was viewed by Israeli military planners as an existential casus belli.

KEY TOPIC 2.2

SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.2 Enquiry: Why Was the Six-Day War Decided in Three Hours, and Did Nasser Intend to Fight? (May–June 1967)

Pearson Specification Focus: Key events and military turning points of the Six-Day War (5–10 June 1967) • Operation Focus dawn airstrikes against the Egyptian Air Force • Three-front combat: Sinai Peninsula, West Bank and East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights • The ceasefire and the redrawn territorial map.

The Spiral into Crisis (May 1967)

[1.1] The crisis that ignited the Six Day War began on 13 May 1967, when the Soviet Union passed false intelligence reports to Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser claiming that Israel was massing twelve military brigades along the Syrian border for an imminent invasion. Although United Nations observers on the ground inspected the frontier and confirmed that no Israeli troop buildup existed, Nasser could not afford to look weak after months of Syrian taunts following the 7 April air battle. To restore his reputation as the undisputed champion of the Arab world, Nasser made three dramatic moves: he marched 100,000 Egyptian troops and 1,000 tanks into the Sinai Peninsula; on 16 May he ordered the immediate expulsion of the United Nations Emergency Force (UNEF) peacekeepers who had secured the border since 1957; and on 22 May he announced the closure of the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping.

[1.2] The closure of the Straits of Tiran was the fatal turning point. The straits were Israel's sole maritime gateway to Asia and East Africa through the southern port of Eilat, and the channel through which 90% of Israel's vital crude oil imports arrived. Back in 1957, Israel had officially notified the international community that closing the straits would be treated as an explicit act of war (*casus belli*). Tension spiked to fever pitch on 30 May 1967, when King Hussein of Jordan flew to Cairo to sign a mutual defense pact, placing the Jordanian army under Egyptian command, while Iraq joined the alliance shortly after. Encircled by hostile armies boasting publicly of driving Israel into the sea, the Israeli cabinet formed a national unity government, appointing war hero General Moshe Dayan as Minister of Defence, and concluded that striking first was the only way to avoid national destruction.

SOURCE A

ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ

22 May 1967

President Gamal Abdel Nasser Announces the Blockade of the Straits of Tiran (22 May 1967)

"The armed forces of the United Arab Republic have reoccupied Sharm el-Sheikh... We will not allow the Israeli flag to pass through the Gulf of Aqaba. Our basic objective will be the destruction of Israel. This war will be a total war and our basic aim will be to destroy Israel."

Presidential Address at UAR Advanced Air HQ / Egyptian State Information Service (22 May 1967)

22 May 1967

The Pre-Emptive Dawn Airstrike (5 June 1967)

[2.1] At 7:45 am on Monday, 5 June 1967, Israel launched a meticulously planned pre-emptive dawn airstrike against Egyptian military airfields. Realising that Israel's small civilian reserve army could not remain mobilized indefinitely without economic collapse, Israeli military planners committed nearly all of their operational jet fighters—leaving only twelve aircraft behind to defend Israel's home skies. Israeli fighter-bombers flew out west over the Mediterranean Sea, skimming just thirty feet above the waves to stay beneath Egyptian radar detection, before looping inland into Egypt from the west at the exact moment Egyptian pilots were finishing breakfast and morning patrols had landed.

[2.2] The surprise attack was an overwhelming tactical triumph. In waves lasting just over two hours, Israeli jets struck seventeen Egyptian airbases, dropping specialized rocket-boosted cratering bombs to destroy concrete runways before strafing parked combat aircraft with cannons. Over 300 Egyptian combat aircraft were destroyed on the ground, wiping out Egypt's air force before it could take off. When Syrian and Jordanian aircraft attempted to retaliate later that morning, Israeli jets struck their airfields as well, destroying a further 100 enemy planes. (Source A) shows the charred ruins of Egyptian MiG fighter jets on the airfield tarmac at Bir Gifgafa in the Sinai, demonstrating how total air supremacy was won in the opening hours of the conflict, leaving Arab ground troops completely exposed to air attack.

SOURCE B

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

5 June 1967

Destroyed Egyptian Jet Aircraft at Bir Gifgafa Airfield, Sinai (5 June 1967)



IDF Military Archive, Western Sinai Campaign Collection (Accession Ref: AIR-1967-0506).

5 June 1967

KEY FIGURE

1915–1981



Moshe Dayan
ISRAELI MINISTER OF DEFENCE (1967–1974)

Dayan became the global symbol of Israeli military dominance and deterrence. His aggressive operational tempo secured total victory across three fronts within 132 hours, fundamentally transforming Middle Eastern borders.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Appointed Minister of Defence on 1 June 1967 amid national crisis to unify the Israeli war cabinet.
- Authorised the pre-emptive dawn air strike that destroyed the Egyptian Air Force on the tarmac.
- Directed three-front combat operations that captured the Sinai Peninsula, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights.

Three Fronts in Six Days

[3.1] With total control of the skies established, the Israeli ground offensive swept across three separate combat fronts. In the Sinai Peninsula, three Israeli armored divisions, commanded by generals including Ariel Sharon, smashed through Egyptian fortified border positions. Deprived of air cover and receiving panicked, contradictory retreat orders from Cairo, the Egyptian army collapsed into a disordered retreat. Within four days, Israeli armored spearheads had reached the eastern bank of the Suez Canal, capturing thousands of Egyptian soldiers and destroying hundreds of tanks.

[3.2] On the eastern front, Jordan had entered the war on the morning of 5 June by shelling Israeli positions in West Jerusalem and suburbs of Tel Aviv, ignoring Israeli diplomatic warnings to remain neutral. Israeli forces counter-attacked immediately into the West Bank, surrounding Jordanian troops in Nablus, Bethlehem, and Hebron. On Wednesday, 7 June, Israeli paratroopers breached the Lions' Gate into the Old City of Jerusalem, capturing the Temple Mount and reaching the Western Wall—the holiest prayer site in Judaism, where Jews had been barred from praying under Jordanian rule since 1948. (Source B) captures the iconic photograph of Israeli paratroopers standing in silence and emotion at the foot of the Western Wall. Finally, on 9–10 June, Israeli infantry and armored units scaled the fortified cliffs of the Golan Heights, driving the Syrian army back to within forty miles of Damascus before a UN ceasefire ended the war.

SOURCE C

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

7 June 1967

Israeli Paratroopers at the Western Wall, Jerusalem (David Rubinger, 7 June 1967)



Photograph by David Rubinger, Israel Government Press Office (Accession Ref: GPO-D597-088).

7 June 1967

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH

IDF GENERAL STAFF ORDER

5 June 1967

Chief of Staff Yitzhak Rabin's Order of the Day

"Soldiers of the Israel Defense Forces! Today our armed forces strike at the forces arrayed to annihilate our people. We go into battle not to conquer, but to secure our survival in our ancestral land. The fate of Israel rests upon your courage and discipline."

IDF General Staff Historical Archive Tel Aviv Command, 5 June 1967

How the Map Changed in Six Days

[4.1] In only six days of combat (5–10 June 1967), the strategic and political map of the Middle East was revolutionized. Israel lost fewer than 1,000 soldiers, while Arab armies suffered catastrophic losses: over 15,000 Egyptian, 6,000 Jordanian, and 1,000 Syrian soldiers were killed, and the bulk of their modern military equipment was destroyed. Israel had quadrupled its territorial footprint, creating a vast strategic buffer zone that included the Sinai Peninsula, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights.

[4.2] However, this triumph created complex long-term problems. By capturing the West Bank and Gaza Strip, Israel brought over one million Palestinian Arabs under military rule, triggering a fresh refugee exodus and fueling a new wave of Palestinian nationalism. While Israelis felt secure behind wide natural borders, the profound humiliation suffered by Egypt and Syria guaranteed that Arab leaders would dedicate their resources to preparing for a war of revenge.

[4.3] In geopolitical terms, the sweeping Israeli victory transformed Cold War dynamics across the Middle East. The Soviet Union severed diplomatic relations with Israel and launched a multi-billion-dollar emergency rearmament of Egypt and Syria. Meanwhile, the United States recognized Israel as its primary regional strategic ally, initiating large-scale military assistance that solidified the post-1967 **regional balance of power**.

TACTICAL MASTERSTROKE

OPERATION MOKED • JUNE 1967

Operation Focus (Moked): The 170-Minute Air Blitz

At 07:45 on 5 June 1967, Israeli Air Force commander Mordechai Hod committed 196 of Israel's 208 combat jets to a daring pre-emptive strike. Flying radar-evading routes just 50 feet above the Mediterranean waves under radio silence, Israeli Mirage and Vautour aircraft struck 19 Egyptian airbases simultaneously using specialized rocket-assisted runway-cratering bombs ('Dibber'). In less than three hours, 309 of Egypt's 340 combat aircraft were demolished on the tarmac. By midday, Hod redirected sorties against Syrian and Jordanian airfields, destroying a further 60 aircraft and winning absolute regional air dominance.

Decisive Factor: Total air supremacy allowed Israeli armored divisions under Tal, Sharon, and Yoffe to advance across Sinai and the West Bank without threat of air interdiction.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • MILITARY DOCTRINE & THE THREE FRONTS (JUNE 1967)			CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING
1. OPERATION FOCUS:	2. MULTI-FRONT ADVANCE:	3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:	
Why was the Israeli Air Force's surprise dawn blitz on 5 June 1967 decisive in determining the entire outcome of the Six-Day War?	Explain why Jordan entered the war despite Israeli warnings, and describe the consequences for East Jerusalem and the	Was Israeli victory primarily the result of brilliant tactical planning (pre-emption) or disastrous Arab disunity and military	

KEY TOPIC 2.3

SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.3 Enquiry: "Land for Peace" or Permanent Stalemate: How Did the 1967 Conquered Territories Transform the Conflict?

Pearson Specification Focus: Significance of the newly occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai, and East Jerusalem • The Palestinian refugee crisis • The Khartoum Arab League Summit and the 'Three Noes' • UN Resolution 242 ('Land for Peace') and the Suez Canal dispute.

The Reality of the Occupied Territories (Summer 1967)

[1.1] In the weeks following the June 1967 ceasefire, the government of Israel confronted a dramatic transformation in its strategic reality. Israel was now in military control of vast territories (Source A): the entire Sinai Peninsula and the Gaza Strip from Egypt, the West Bank and East Jerusalem from Jordan, and the Golan Heights from Syria. Israel's total land area had quadrupled. Israeli military planners celebrated the creation of wide natural buffer zones—the wide expanse of the Sinai desert, the water barrier of the Suez Canal, the Jordan River valley, and the high cliffs of the Golan Heights—which made surprise ground attacks against Israel's heartland far more difficult.

[1.2] However, this triumph created immediate humanitarian and political dilemmas. By occupying the West Bank and Gaza Strip, Israel brought over one million Palestinian Arabs under its direct military rule. Between 300,000 and 350,000 Palestinians fled or were displaced across the River Jordan into overcrowded refugee camps in Jordan during and immediately after the fighting. For many, this was their second displacement within twenty years, having previously fled during the 1948 war. Israel immediately annexed East Jerusalem, declaring the unified city its eternal capital, while placing the West Bank and Gaza under a military governor. Shortly afterwards, the first civilian Jewish settlements were established in strategic zones such as the Jordan Valley and Gush Etzion, beginning a process that would profoundly complicate any future territorial compromise.

SOURCE A

HISTORICAL MAP

June 1967

The Conquered Occupied Territories Following the Six-Day War (June 1967)



Central Intelligence Agency Cartographic Center / United Nations
June
Disengagement Observer Force Archive (Accession Ref: UN-MAP-1967-
1967 ME).

The Khartoum Summit & The "Three Noes"

[2.1] The scale of the Arab military defeat produced immense shock and humiliation across the Arab world. From 29 August to 1 September 1967, the heads of state of eight Arab nations gathered in Khartoum, the capital of Sudan, to coordinate their joint response. Moderate leaders, including King Hussein of Jordan, quietly urged a pragmatic diplomatic approach to negotiate the return of the captured territories. However, hardline sentiment dominated the conference. President Nasser of Egypt and Syrian leaders argued that offering political concessions or recognising Israel while Arab lands remained occupied would validate Israeli military aggression and humiliate the Arab nation permanently.

[2.2] The conference ended with a categorical, unyielding resolution that became universally known as the "Three Noes" of Khartoum: "no peace with Israel, no recognition of Israel, no negotiations with it." (Source B) records the third clause of the Khartoum Communiqué, setting out the collective Arab rejection of direct peace talks. In Israel, the Khartoum declaration was received as definitive proof that Arab governments remained dedicated to Israel's total destruction, regardless of what territorial compromises Israel might offer. Consequently, the Israeli cabinet abandoned early ideas of offering land back in exchange for peace, hardening Israeli resolve to hold the Occupied Territories indefinitely.

SOURCE B

ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ

1 September 1967

The Khartoum Arab League Summit Resolution (1 September 1967)

"The Arab Heads of State have agreed to united political efforts at the international and diplomatic level to eliminate the effects of aggression and to ensure the withdrawal of the aggressive Israeli forces from the Arab lands which have been occupied since the aggression of 5 June. This will be done within the framework of the main principles by which the Arab States abide, namely: no peace with Israel, no recognition of Israel, no negotiations with it, and adherence to the rights of the Palestinian people in their own country."

Arab League Summit Records, Khartoum Communiqué, Clause 3 1 September
(1 September 1967).
1967

UN Resolution 242 & "Land for Peace"

[3.1] Alarmed that the Middle East remained an active battlefield that could drag the United States and the Soviet Union into a direct superpower collision, the United Nations Security Council spent months drafting a compromise framework. On 22 November 1967, the Security Council unanimously adopted Resolution 242, authored primarily by the British ambassador to the UN, Lord Caradon. Resolution 242 introduced the historic formula of "Land for Peace": it declared the inadmissibility of the acquisition of territory by war and called for the "withdrawal of Israel armed forces from territories occupied in the recent conflict," in exchange for the termination of all states of belligerency and the acknowledgement of the right of every state in the area to live in peace within secure and recognised boundaries.

[3.2] However, Resolution 242 contained a deliberate linguistic ambiguity that prevented its successful implementation. (Source C) contrasts the English text with the equally binding French translation. The English text called for Israeli withdrawal from "territories occupied," deliberately omitting the definite article "the." Israel and the United States argued this meant Israel was required to withdraw only from *some* territories, allowing minor border adjustments to ensure "secure and recognised boundaries." Conversely, Arab states pointed to the French version ("retrait des forces armées israéliennes des territoires occupés"), insisting that "des" meant *all* the occupied territories. Furthermore, the resolution referred to the displaced Palestinians only as "the refugee problem," completely ignoring their national aspirations for statehood.

SOURCE C

DIPLOMATIC TREATY

22 November 1967

Article 1(i) of UN Security Council Resolution 242 in English and French

"Article 1(i) of UN Security Council Resolution 242 (Adopted 22 November 1967): [Official English Text – Drafted by Lord Caradon, UK]: 'Affirms that the fulfilment of Charter principles requires the establishment of a just and lasting peace in the Middle East which should include the application of both the following principles: (i) Withdrawal of Israel armed forces from territories occupied in the recent conflict...'

[Official French Text – Equally Authoritative Official UN Record]: 'Affirme que l'accomplissement des principes de la Charte exige l'instauration d'une paix juste et durable au Moyen-Orient, qui devrait comprendre l'application des deux principes suivants: (i) Retrait des forces armées israéliennes des territoires occupés lors du récent conflit...'

[Linguistic Significance]: The English text deliberately omits the definite article 'the' ('from territories occupied'), enabling Israel to argue it is only required to withdraw from *SOME* occupied territories to secure defensible borders. Conversely, the French text uses 'des territoires occupés' ('from *THE* occupied territories'), enabling Arab governments to insist that international law mandates complete withdrawal from *ALL* occupied lands."

United Nations Security Council Official Records, 22 November 1967 (Resolution 242 / S/RES/242).

22 November 1967

The Roots of Entrenched Conflict

[4.1] In the long term, the aftermath of the 1967 war fundamentally changed the character of the Arab-Israeli conflict. Instead of settling the dispute, the conquest of the Occupied Territories created a stubborn diplomatic stalemate. On the ground, Israel constructed extensive military fortifications—most notably the Bar-Lev Line along the Suez Canal—and subsidized civilian settlements in the West Bank and Gaza, cementing Israeli presence in the territories. In the Arab world, the humiliation of conventional defeat convinced Palestinians that Arab state governments would never liberate their land, accelerating the rise of independent guerrilla organisations like the PLO.

KEY FIGURE

1898–1978



Golda Meir

PRIME MINISTER OF ISRAEL (1969–1974)

Known as the 'Iron Lady' of Israeli politics, Meir maintained uncompromising diplomatic resolve following the 1967 war, adhering strictly to 'secure borders' and refusing unilateral territorial concessions without mutual recognition.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Assumed the premiership in March 1969 following the death of Levi Eshkol, governing during the War of Attrition.
- Consolidated Israeli control over the conquered territories, fortifying the Bar-Lev Line along the Suez Canal.
- Firmly rejected unconditional withdrawal without direct, face-to-face Arab peace treaties and recognized borders.

[4.2] United Nations Resolution 242 remained the recognized framework for all future Middle East peace diplomacy for the next thirty years, but in the late 1960s, it proved completely incapable of bridging the divide. With Arab governments adhering strictly to the "Three Noes" of Khartoum and Israel refusing any unilateral withdrawal without direct peace treaties, the stage was set for the continuous artillery duels of the War of Attrition and, ultimately, the surprise assault of the 1973 Yom Kippur War.

KEY TOPIC 2.4

SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.4: The Rise of Palestinian Resistance: The PLO, Black September & Munich

(1968–1972)

Pearson Specification Focus: The rise of independent Palestinian armed resistance • Use of international terrorism, Israeli responses, and changing world attitudes: PFLP commercial aircraft hijackings to Dawson's Field (1970) • King Hussein's expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (Black September) • The 1972 Munich Olympics massacre.

From Dependence to Armed Resistance (1968–1969)

[1.1] The disastrous defeat of Arab state armies in the 1967 Six Day War destroyed Palestinian confidence in Arab leaders like Gamal Abdel Nasser. For nineteen years, Palestinians had waited for regular Arab armies to defeat Israel and restore their homeland. After 1967, young Palestinians decided that they had to take their destiny into their own hands, joining independent armed guerrilla organisations known as *fedayeen* ("those who sacrifice themselves"). The defining turning point occurred on 21 March 1968 at the town of Karameh inside Jordan. When a large Israeli armored force crossed the border to destroy guerrilla camps, Palestinian fighters belonging to Yasser Arafat's Fatah movement chose to stand and fight alongside Jordanian artillery rather than retreating into the surrounding hills.

[1.2] The Battle of Karameh was a military victory for Israel, which destroyed the guerrilla base and killed over 100 fighters. However, Palestinian guerrillas inflicted unusually heavy casualties on the Israeli Defence Forces, killing 28 Israeli soldiers and disabling several tanks. Across the Arab world, Karameh was celebrated as a legendary moral victory—the first time Arab fighters had stood their ground and inflicted serious losses on the Israeli army. Thousands of young men volunteered to join Fatah in the weeks that followed. In February 1969, Yasser Arafat was elected Chairman of the PLO, cementing Fatah's leadership and transforming the PLO from a corrupt diplomatic group controlled by Arab heads of state into an independent, armed national liberation movement.

SOURCE A

ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ

21 March 1968

Fatah Communiqué No. 12 Following the Battle of Karameh (21 March 1968)

"In the town of Karameh, the fighters of Fatah and the Palestinian resistance stood shoulder to shoulder against Israeli armor... The myth of Israeli invincibility has been buried forever in the Jordan Valley. Thousands of our youth are flocking to join the armed revolution."

Fatah Military High Command / PLO Central Archive, Amman

21 March 1968

(March 1968)

KEY FIGURE

1929–2004



Yasser Arafat
CHAIRMAN OF THE PLO / LEADER OF FATAH (1969–2004)

Arafat transformed the Palestinian cause from a passive refugee dilemma into an autonomous political and paramilitary movement, demonstrating that Palestinians would fight independently rather than wait for Arab armies.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Led Fatah armed guerrillas at the 1968 Battle of Karameh, boosting Palestinian recruitment and prestige.
- Elected Chairman of the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) in 1969, shifting it to independent armed struggle.
- Established an armed state-within-a-state in Jordan until expelled during the brutal Black September civil war of 1970.

Dawson's Field & The Crisis of Black September

(1970)

[2.1] By 1970, the growing strength of Palestinian guerrilla groups inside Jordan had created an unsustainable crisis. Armed guerrillas operated as a "state within a state" in the capital city of Amman, setting up roadblocks, carrying loaded assault rifles in public, refusing to pay Jordanian taxes, and ignoring police authority. Radical Marxist splinter groups, most notably George Habash's Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP), believed that small-scale border raids would never force Western superpowers to pay attention to Palestine. The PFLP pioneered international airplane hijackings to capture world headlines. In early September 1970, PFLP militants staged their most daring operation, hijacking four Western commercial airliners bound for New York.

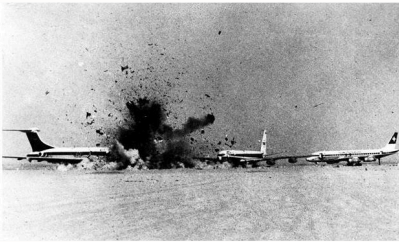
[2.2] Three of the hijacked aircraft (Swissair, TWA, and BOAC flights) were forced to land at Dawson's Field, a remote desert airstrip in northern Jordan. After holding over 300 passengers hostage for several days, the hijackers released the passengers and blew up the multi-million-dollar airliners in front of international media cameras. (Source A) shows the charred, smoking ruins of the blown-up passenger planes at Dawson's Field, an act of defiance that directly threatened the authority and sovereignty of King Hussein of Jordan. Realising that his kingdom was descending into anarchy, King Hussein declared martial law on 17 September 1970. The Jordanian army launched an all-out offensive against Palestinian militias in Amman in a bloody civil war known as "Black September." After ten days of heavy fighting that cost thousands of lives, Palestinian fighters were crushed, and by mid-1971, the PLO and its forces were completely expelled from Jordan, relocating their headquarters to southern Lebanon.

SOURCE B

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

12 September 1970

PFLP Militants Detonating Hijacked Commercial Airliners at Dawson's Field, Jordan (12 September 1970)



Associated Press Photo Archive, Amman Bureau (Accession Ref: 12 September AP-JOR-1970-0912).

1970

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS			DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY
Fatah & The PLO Palestinian nationalist political and military	Black September (1970) Armed conflict between Jordanian Armed	Munich Olympics (1972) Terrorist attack by the Black September	

The 1972 Munich Olympics Massacre

[3.1] Driven into exile in Lebanon and burning for revenge against King Hussein and Israel, radical Palestinian militants formed a covert terrorist cell calling itself "Black September." On 5 September 1972, during the Summer Olympic Games in Munich, West Germany, eight heavily armed Black September militants scaled the wire fence of the Olympic Village. They forced their way into the quarters of the Israeli Olympic team, immediately shooting dead a weightlifter and a wrestling coach who tried to resist, and taking nine other Israeli athletes, coaches, and referees hostage.

[3.2] The militants demanded the immediate release of 234 Palestinian prisoners held in Israeli jails. Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir flatly refused, stating that giving in to blackmail would endanger Israelis and Jewish people worldwide. German authorities arranged to transport the terrorists and hostages by helicopter to the nearby Fürstenfeldbruck airbase, pretending they would be flown to Egypt, while secretly preparing a police ambush. However, the German rescue attempt was disastrously mismanaged: snipers had no night-vision equipment or radio communication, and armored vehicles arrived late. In the resulting firefight on the tarmac, a terrorist tossed a grenade into one helicopter, while another gunman shot the hostages in the second helicopter. All nine remaining Israeli hostages, five terrorists, and one German police officer were killed. (Source B) shows the chilling photograph of a masked Black September gunman on the Olympic village balcony, an image beamed live by television into hundreds of millions of living rooms around the globe. In response, Golda Meir authorized the Mossad intelligence agency to track down and assassinate the planners of the massacre in a covert campaign known as "Operation Wrath of God."

SOURCE C

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

5 September 1972

Masked Black September Gunman on the Balcony at Munich Olympic Village (5 September 1972)



Kurt Strumpf / Associated Press Archive (Accession Ref: AP-MUC-1972-0509).

5 September 1972

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH

CABINET SECURITY DIRECTIVE

September 1972

Golda Meir's Directive: Operation Wrath of God

Following the massacre of eleven Israeli Olympic athletes in Munich, Prime Minister Golda Meir authorized Mossad to track down and assassinate every Black September planner across Europe and the Middle East, declaring: "We have no choice but to strike at the terrorist organizations wherever we can reach them."

Prime Minister's Office Classified Minutes

Jerusalem Security Committee, September 1972

Did Terrorism Help or Harm the Cause?

[4.1] The turn to international terrorism between 1968 and 1972 had deeply contradictory consequences for the Palestinian struggle. On the one hand, spectacular attacks like the Dawson's Field hijackings and the Munich Olympics forced the international community to acknowledge that the Palestinian problem was not simply a humanitarian refugee issue, but an unresolved political struggle for national self-determination. By 1974, the United Nations invited Yasser Arafat to address the General Assembly as the recognized representative of the Palestinian people.

[4.2] On the other hand, terrorism caused severe strategic damage to the Palestinian national cause. In Jordan, reckless armed militancy brought about the catastrophe of Black September, costing thousands of Palestinian lives and depriving the PLO of its border with Israel. Internationally, the Munich massacre alienated Western governments and justified aggressive Israeli military reprisals. While violence won global headlines, it ultimately demonstrated that terrorism alone could never defeat Israel or achieve an independent state, prompting Yasser Arafat to gradually steer the PLO towards international diplomacy in the mid-1970s.

HISTORICAL TURNING POINT

GUERRILLA LEGITIMACY • MARCH 1968

The Battle of Karameh: How a Tactical Clash Created a Legend

On 21 March 1968, 15,000 Israeli soldiers launched a punitive raid across the Jordan River into the town of Karameh to destroy PLO basecamps. Anticipating the assault, Yasser Arafat ordered Fatah commandos to stand their ground alongside the Jordanian Army's 1st Infantry Division. Despite suffering 156 dead and the destruction of the town, Palestinian fighters destroyed 4 Israeli tanks and inflicted 28 IDF fatalities. Arafat framed Karameh as the first time Arab fighters stood against the IDF without fleeing, sparking a massive surge in Palestinian nationalist enlistment across the Middle East.

Key Significance: Transformed Fatah from an obscure guerrilla fringe into the dominant political vanguard of the Palestinian national movement.

KEY TOPIC 2.5

SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.5: The War of Attrition & The Yom Kippur War (1969–1973)

Pearson Specification Focus: Egyptian relations with Israel, the superpowers (USA/USSR), and the Arab world under Nasser and Sadat • The War of Attrition (1969–70) and Israel's consolidation of occupied lands • Key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973): Egyptian Suez crossing, Syrian assault, IDF counter-encirclement, and the OPEC oil crisis.

The Impasse of Attrition & Anwar Sadat's Plan (1969–1973)

[1.1] Following the 1967 war, Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser refused to accept Israeli occupation of the Sinai Peninsula. In March 1969, Nasser launched the "War of Attrition"—a prolonged campaign of heavy artillery bombardments, commando raids, and aerial dogfights across the Suez Canal designed to inflict unsustainable casualties on the small Israeli army. In response, Israel constructed the "Bar-Lev Line," an elaborate chain of fortified concrete bunkers and massive sand ramparts over sixty feet high running the entire length of the canal. The War of Attrition dragged on until an American-brokered ceasefire in August 1970, which cost over 10,000 Egyptian and 360 Israeli lives without shifting the front lines by an inch.

[1.2] When Nasser died of a heart attack in September 1970, he was succeeded by his vice-president, Anwar Sadat. Observers in Israel and Washington initially dismissed Sadat as a weak leader. However, Sadat possessed a bold, realistic strategic vision. He recognized that Egypt's economy was crumbling under immense military spending and that Israel would never surrender the Sinai Peninsula through peaceful diplomacy while it enjoyed total military superiority. Sadat did not plan an impossible war to destroy Israel; instead, he planned a limited, high-intensity surprise offensive to cross the canal, seize a secure bridgehead in the Sinai, shatter the myth of Israeli invincibility, and force the American superpower to intervene and broker a comprehensive peace.

SOURCE A

HISTORICAL DOCUMENT

1969–1972

Archival Intelligence Report: The Construction and Doctrine of the Israeli Bar-Lev Line Along the Suez Canal (1969–1972)

"The Bar-Lev Line consists of thirty-five fortified strongpoints (Maozim) sunk into sand ramparts sixty feet above the waterline, backed by concrete artillery emplacements and oil-pipe flame barriers. Designed to withstand weeks of sustained Egyptian bombardment, it provides total tactical security for Israeli forces in Sinai."

IDF General Staff Historical Division, Tel Aviv (Accession Ref: IDF-SUEZ-BL-1971)

1969–1972

KEY FIGURE

1918–1981



Anwar Sadat
PRESIDENT OF EGYPT (1970–1981)

Sadat used limited military warfare not to destroy Israel, but to break the diplomatic stalemate, force superpower intervention, and regain Arab honor, paving the way for eventual peace negotiations.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Succeeded Nasser in 1970 and expelled 15,000 Soviet military advisers in 1972 to gain independent strategic freedom.
- Orchestrated a synchronized surprise attack with Syria on Yom Kippur (6 October 1973).
- Breached the Bar-Lev Line using high-pressure water cannons, shattering the myth of Israeli invincibility.

The Surprise Assault on the Holy Day (6 October 1973)

[2.1] On Saturday, 6 October 1973, at 2:00 pm, Egypt and Syria launched a coordinated surprise assault on two fronts. The timing was chosen with meticulous care: it was Yom Kippur, the holiest day in Judaism, when Israeli radio stations were silent, roads were empty, and many soldiers were home with their families or fasting in synagogues. It was also the Muslim holy month of Ramadan. In the north, 1,400 Syrian tanks surged across the Golan Heights armistice line, overwhelming thin Israeli defensive units. In the south, over 80,000 Egyptian infantrymen crossed the Suez Canal on assault rafts under cover of a massive 2,000-gun artillery bombardment.

[2.2] The Egyptian army executed a brilliant engineering feat. Rather than using conventional explosives to clear the massive sand ramparts of the Bar-Lev Line, Egyptian engineers deployed high-pressure water turbines pumping water directly from the canal, washing away thousands of tons of sand in hours to create bridge ramps. (Source A) shows Egyptian infantry crossing the Suez Canal on pontoon bridges and planting the Egyptian flag on the captured ramparts. When Israeli jet fighters and tanks rushed forward to counter-attack, they were devastated by mobile Soviet-supplied surface-to-air missiles (SAM-6) and wire-guided anti-tank missiles (Saggers). In the first forty-eight hours of combat, Israel lost over 150 tanks and dozens of aircraft, plunging the Israeli leadership into panic.

SOURCE B

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

October 1973

Egyptian Infantry and Armored Columns Crossing the Suez Canal (October 1973)



Egyptian Armed Forces Directorate of Moral Affairs (Accession Ref: EGY-1973-1006).

October 1973

Superpower Airlifts, Sharon's Crossing & The Oil Weapon

[3.1] Facing critical shortages of ammunition and equipment, Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir appealed urgently to the United States. US President Richard Nixon ordered a massive emergency military airlift, flying hundreds of transport planes loaded with tanks, artillery shells, and electronic countermeasures directly to Israeli airfields. Simultaneously, the Soviet Union launched an airlift to resupply Egypt and Syria. Having stabilized the northern front in fierce tank battles in the Golan Heights, Israeli armored divisions under General Ariel Sharon found an undefended seam between Egypt's Second and Third Armies. On the night of 15 October, Sharon's forces crossed to the western bank of the Suez Canal on pontoon rafts, establishing a bridgehead inside mainland Egypt. (Source B) shows Israeli tanks and armor crossing to the western bank, where they severed Egyptian supply lines and encircled Egypt's 30,000-strong Third Army.

[3.2] As the military balance swung violently back towards Israel, the conflict triggered a global crisis. On 17 October, the Organisation of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC), led by Saudi Arabia, deployed the "oil weapon." Arab nations cut oil production by 5% per month and placed a total oil embargo on the United States and the Netherlands. The price of crude oil quadrupled from \$3 to nearly \$12 a barrel, causing catastrophic petrol shortages, inflation, and economic panic across the Western world. Meanwhile, when the Soviet Union threatened to deploy airborne troops to save the surrounded Egyptian Third Army, the United States placed its nuclear armed forces on worldwide DEFCON 3 alert. US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger flew urgently between Moscow, Tel Aviv, and Cairo, finally securing a binding UN ceasefire on 24 October 1973.

SOURCE C

ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH

October 1973

Israeli Armored Vehicles and Tanks Crossing the Suez Canal to the West Bank (October 1973)



IDF Military Archive, Southern Command Photographic Unit (Accession Ref: YKW-1973-1018)

October 1973

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH

PRESIDENTIAL WAR DIRECTIVE

5 October 1973

President Anwar Sadat's Strategic War Directive

"The strategic objective of the Egyptian armed forces is to challenge Israeli military doctrine by launching a military action... to shatter the theory of Israeli security and force a political crisis that will compel international intervention to resolve the stalemate."

Egyptian Supreme Council of the Armed Forces

War Directive No. 41, 5 October 1973

The Turning Point Towards Peace

[4.1] The Yom Kippur War of 1973 was a profound psychological and political earthquake for both sides. For Israel, although its army had recovered to surround enemy forces within fifty miles of Cairo and Damascus, the cost had been catastrophic: over 2,600 Israeli soldiers killed and the shattering of the nation's supreme confidence in military invincibility. A subsequent government inquiry (the Agranat Commission) forced the resignation of military chiefs and contributed to Prime Minister Golda Meir stepping down in 1974.

[4.2] For Egypt, although militarily contained at the end, the war was celebrated as a monumental national victory. By successfully crossing the Suez Canal and standing toe-to-toe with the IDF, Egypt had wiped away the shame of 1967 and restored Arab pride. Crucially, this restored dignity gave Anwar Sadat the political authority he needed to negotiate with Israel as an equal. The war had proven to Israelis that occupying land did not guarantee security, while the OPEC oil crisis forced the United States to commit permanently to Middle Eastern peace diplomacy. The road was now open for Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy, Sadat's historic 1977 visit to Jerusalem, and the 1978 Camp David Accords.

ENGINEERING TRIUMPH

OPERATION BADR • OCTOBER 1973

Breaching the Bar-Lev Line: The High-Pressure Water Cannons

The Israeli Bar-Lev Line was shielded by a 60-foot-high sand rampart along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal, calculated by Western engineers to require 24 to 48 hours and heavy explosives to breach. Egyptian military engineer General Baki Zaki Yousef proposed using commercial British-built high-pressure water pumps. Mounting 450 pumps on pontoon barges, Egyptian engineering units blasted 81 separate breaches through 3 million cubic meters of sand in less than five hours, enabling 100,000 soldiers and 1,020 tanks to surge into Sinai before the IDF could mobilize.

Strategic Shock: Shattered Israel's doctrine of 'The Concept' (Hamusag)—the misplaced conviction that Arab armies lacked the technical sophistication to mount a crossing.

KEY TOPIC 2: CHRONOLOGY & DISCIPLINARY MASTERY (1964–1973)

Comprehensive revision index of vital historical turning points, diplomatic resolutions, and Edexcel examination question frameworks.

KEY TOPIC 2 MASTER TIMELINE • CRITICAL CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE		
Jan 1964	Cairo Arab League Summit	Arab states endorse headwater diversion scheme against Israel's National Water Carrier; PLO created.
Nov 1966	Samu Reprisal Raid	IDF launches heavy raid into Jordanian West Bank after Fatah mine kills 3 soldiers; radicalizes West Bank.
7 Apr 1967	Tractor War Air Dogfight	Syrian shelling of DMZ tractors leads to dogfight; IAF downs 6 Syrian MiGs and flies over Damascus.
May 1967	Sinai Mobilization & Blockade	Soviet disinformation prompts Nasser to demand UNEF withdrawal and close Straits of Tiran.
5 Jun 1967	Operation Focus (Moked)	IAF pre-emptive dawn strike neutralizes Egyptian air force on runways, establishing complete air dominance.
5–10 Jun 1967	The Six-Day War	IDF captures Sinai, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Syrian Golan Heights; territory expands x3.
Sep 1967	Khartoum Resolution	Eight Arab heads of state proclaim the 'Three Noes': No peace, no recognition, no negotiations with Israel.
22 Nov 1967	UN Resolution 242	Security Council establishes 'Land for Peace' formula: Israeli withdrawal in exchange for recognized boundaries.
21 Mar 1968	Battle of Karameh	Fatah fighters and Jordanian army resist IDF raid, transforming Arafat into an international Palestinian icon.
Sep 1970	Dawson's Field & Black September	PFLP hijacks 4 planes to Jordan; King Hussein unleashes army to crush and expel PLO fedayeen to Lebanon.
Sep 1972	Munich Olympics Massacre	Black September murders 11 Israeli Olympic athletes; Israel responds with 'Operation Wrath of God'.
6–25 Oct 1973	The Yom Kippur War	Coordinated Egyptian-Syrian surprise crossing of Suez and Golan; Sharon counter-encirclement; OPEC oil crisis.

KEY DISCIPLINARY TERMINOLOGY

- **Casus Belli:** An act or event that provokes or is used to justify a declaration of war.
- **Pre-emptive Strike:** A military attack launched to repel or defeat an imminent offensive.
- **Strategic Depth:** Distances between frontiers and core civilian/industrial population centres.
- **Land for Peace:** Legal principle of returning occupied territory in exchange for recognized peace.
- **Asymmetrical Warfare:** Armed conflict between belligerents whose military power differs vastly.
- **The Concept (Hamusag):** Pre-1973 Israeli intelligence assumption that Egypt would not attack without air parity.

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAMINATION FRAMEWORKS

Q1: Explain one consequence of... [4 Marks]
Model Focus: State one clear consequence • Support with precise factual detail (names, dates, figures) • Explain the resulting historical impact on regional tension.

Q2: Write an analytical narrative explaining... [8 Marks]
Model Focus: 3-stage causal sequencing (Catalyst • Escalation • Outcome) • Connect each step with explicit analytical connectives (Consequently, This directly led to).

Q3: Explain two of the following... [16 Marks]
Model Focus: 2 sustained PEEL paragraphs per chosen option • Prioritize causal mechanisms over simple narrative • Conclude with clear comparative significance.